

Getting too close to them will drive them away. Get the settings ready, and take as many shots as possible. When photographing insects, it is a good idea to increase the quality of your photographs as much as possible. A large image size lets you crop to a relevant area better. If the insect is fickle, it's a good idea to go for auto-focus and hope for the best. Approach carefully, and with slow movements, click photos while approaching in case it gets away. If you are taking photos of insects in flight, track it with the lens of the camera and click. When it comes to insects, it is preferable to use the zoom as much as possible, then move in with the lens.

By and large, try to click photos around the afternoon. This is when the light is ideal for macro photography. At noon, the shadows are too harsh. Also, remember that going in too close is not always a good idea. Capturing a bit of the background can make the subject stand out.

Photographing non-nature macros are relatively easy, and let you do more preparation. This is where you can set the background and the lights, as well as luxuriously take a lot of photos. You have a lot of time to experiment. The important thing here is to bring out the details in your subject. Look at where the light is falling, what aspects it is highlighting, and where you are focussing. Experiment with focus brackets here, that is, take a number of shots with a different focus settings.

5.2 Telescopic

Modern day point-and-shoot cameras have a healthy zoom available. Filling the frame with remote or inaccessible features of a landscape is all well and good, and indeed the only way to get these shots, but there are many more uses of the zoom feature.

While photographing people in action, like a cricket match, the zoom is very helpful in letting you take shots without getting in the way. Staying away from the scene of action is helpful while taking photographs of pets, children or candid shots of people without intruding or making them self-conscious.

When using this feature, an optical zoom is always preferable to a digital zoom. If possible, turn off the digital zoom